Manuel Schick

Postdoctoral Researcher, Chair of Econometrics, Heidelberg University

manuel.schick@awi.uni-heidelberg.de
Alfred Weber Institute for Economics
Room 01.020, Bergheimer Str. 58, 69115 Heidelberg, Germany
Homepage | GitHub | LinkedIn | SSRN

Research Interests

Macroeconomic forecasting, density and tail risk modeling, survey expectations, econometrics, empirical finance.

Education

Grades reported on the German scale (1.0 = highest, 4.0 = lowest passing grade).

09/2020–08/2026 **PhD in Economics**, Heidelberg University
Dissertation: "Essays on Macroeconomic Forecasting and Risk using the Survey of Professional Forecasters"
Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Christian Conrad (first), Associate Prof. Anne Opschoor, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (second)

09/2020–08/2021 **Visiting PhD Student**, University of Mannheim
Center for Doctoral Studies in Economics (CDSE)
First-year PhD coursework: Mathematics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics I–III (GPA: 1.5)

10/2017–08/2020 **M.Sc. Economics and Finance**, University of Tübingen
Thesis: "Indirect Inference Estimation of Stochastic Volatility Models using Neural Networks" (GPA: 1.1)

10/2013–03/2017 **B.Sc. Economics and Business Administration**, University of Tübingen (GPA: 1.7)

Research

Working Papers

Job Market Paper **"Nowcasting Growth-at-Risk using the Survey of Professional Forecasters"**
This paper investigates nowcasting Growth-at-Risk (GaR) using consensus forecasts from the Survey of Professional Forecasters (SPF) in the US. Incorporating SPF consensus forecasts into the conditional mean of an AR-GARCH-type model significantly enhances nowcasting accuracy for GaR and the conditional density of GDP growth. Using US data from 1990 to 2024, the findings reveal strong time variation in both the lower and upper quantiles of the GDP growth distribution, underscoring the value of SPF consensus projections for real-time monitoring of tail risks to economic growth.
PDF · SSRN · Interactive tool

with Anne Opschoor **"Multivariate Economic Tail Risk and Scenario Analysis using the Survey of Professional Forecasters"**
Forecasts joint tail risks of GDP growth, inflation, and unemployment using SPF consensus forecasts in multivariate AR-GARCH models, enabling scenario-based analysis of conditional tail risks.
PDF · SSRN

Work in Progress

with Friederike Becker — **"Implied Quarterly Forecasts from Annual Projections in the ECB Survey of Professional Forecasters"**
Recovers quarterly fixed-horizon GDP growth forecasts from annual fixed-event projections via a Kalman filter and smoother.
Draft

with Anne Opschoor — **"Forecasting 10-Day-Ahead Portfolio Value-at-Risk and Expected Shortfall: Univariate, Multivariate, and Copula Approaches"**
Compares univariate, multivariate, and copula-based models for Basel-style multi-day risk forecasts; simple copula models perform best.
Code

Academic Positions

10/2026–04/2027	**Postdoctoral Researcher**, Chair of Econometrics, Heidelberg University
02/2026–09/2026	**Postdoctoral Researcher**, Finance Department, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
09/2020–01/2026	**PhD Candidate**, Chair of Econometrics, Heidelberg University (thesis submitted 04/2026, defended 08/2026)
04/2020–08/2020	**Tutor**, Chair of Statistics, Econometrics and Quantitative Methods, University of Tübingen
10/2018–03/2020	**Tutor**, Chair of Econometrics, Statistics and Empirical Economics, University of Tübingen
10/2017–08/2020	**Student Assistant**, Institute for Applied Economic Research (IAW), Tübingen
05/2017–09/2017	**Intern**, Mergers & Acquisitions, Daimler AG
02/2017–04/2017	**Intern**, Institute for Applied Economic Research (IAW), Tübingen

Teaching

Lectures

Winter 26/27	**Advanced Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Winter 22/23–26/27	**Preparatory Course: Advanced Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master) [Evaluation]

Tutorials

Winter 20/21–25/26	**Advanced Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Winter 24/25	**Advanced Macroeconomics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Summer 23, 25	**Financial Econometrics**, Heidelberg University (Master)
Summer 22	**Empirische Wirtschaftsforschung** (Empirical Economics), Heidelberg University (Bachelor)
Summer 21, 24	**Makroökonometrie** (Macroeconometrics), Heidelberg University (Bachelor)

Winter 19/20	**Quantitative Methoden der Wirtschaftswissenschaften** (Quantitative Methods in Economics), University of Tübingen (Bachelor)
Summer 19, 20	**Wahrscheinlichkeit und Risiko** (Probability and Risk), University of Tübingen (Bachelor)
Winter 18/19	**Explorative Datenanalyse** (Exploratory Data Analysis), University of Tübingen (Bachelor)

Conferences & Talks

2026	13th HKMetrics Workshop (KIT Karlsruhe), IAAE Annual Conference (Lisbon), Econometrics Department Brownbag (VU Amsterdam), 3rd CESA Workshop for Young Researchers (Hagen; *invited*), Finance@VU Lunch Seminar (VU Amsterdam)
2025	Workshop on Macro- and Financial Econometrics (Örebro), Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference (Cologne), 12th HKMetrics Workshop (ZEW Mannheim)
2024	SoFiE Summer School (Brussels), Internal Seminar (Heidelberg), Financial Econometrics & Macroeconomic Expectations Workshop (Heidelberg)
2023	10th HKMetrics Research Network Workshop (KIT Karlsruhe), Macro & Econometrics Workshop (Heidelberg)
2022	16th International Conference on Computational and Financial Econometrics (London)

Academic Service

Sep 2024	**Discussant**, "Assessing the Ex-Ante Uncertainty in the US-SPF" by Malte Knüppel and Lora Pavlova, ZEW-FMT Workshop

Skills

Languages	German (native), English (fluent, written and spoken)
Software	MATLAB (advanced), Stata (advanced), R (intermediate), Gauss (intermediate), LaTeX (advanced)

References

Prof. Dr. Christian Conrad
Chair of Econometrics
Heidelberg University
christian.conrad@awi.uni-heidelberg.de

Dr. Anne Opschoor
Associate Professor, Department of Finance
Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
a.opschoor@vu.nl

Prof. Dr. Timo Dimitriadis
Professor of Econometrics
Goethe University Frankfurt
dimitriadis@econ.uni-frankfurt.de